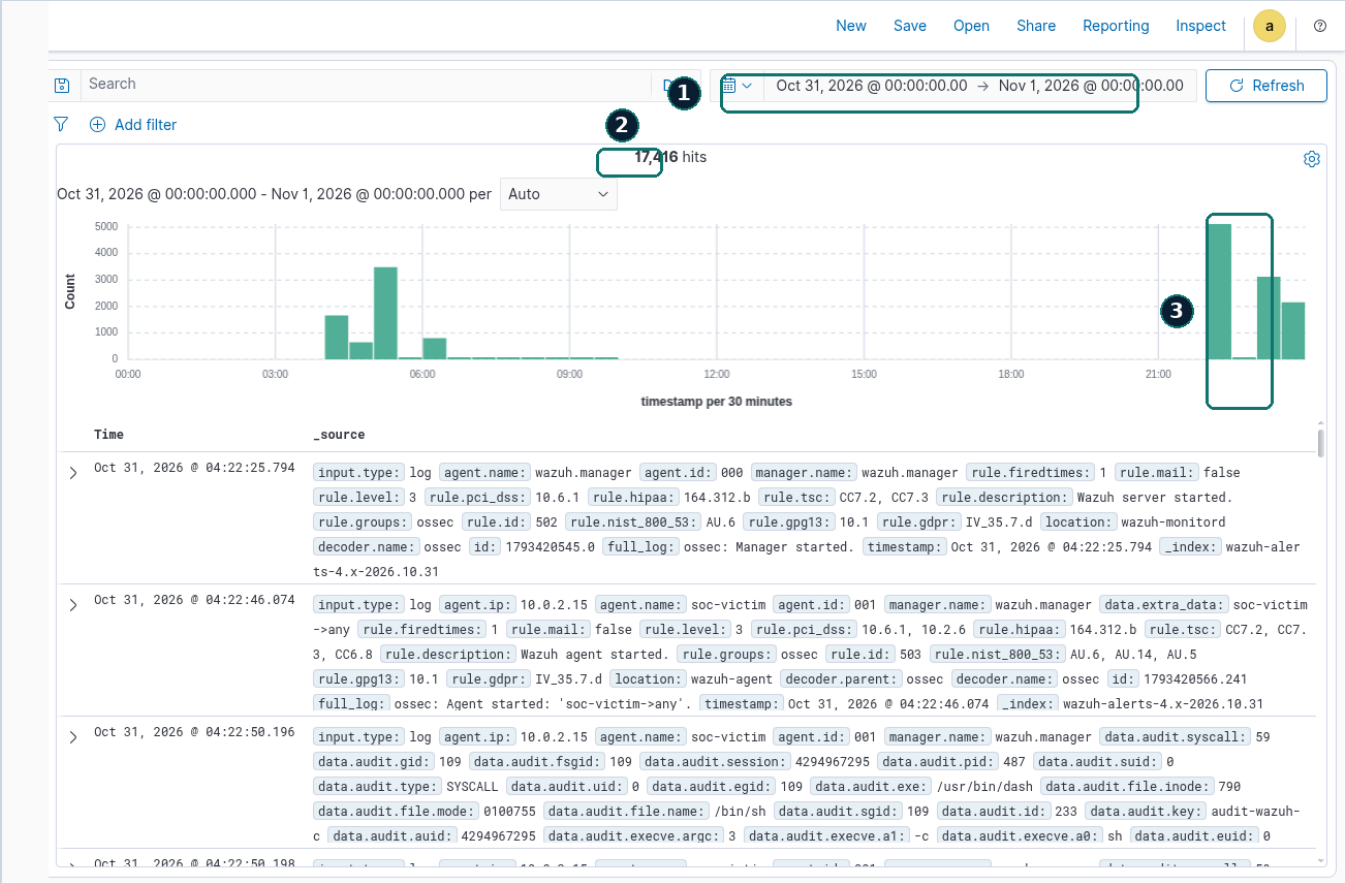
INCIDENT EVIDENCE WALKTHROUGH

Authorized change, no incident

INC-006 · Closed, benign true positive · 31 October 2026 · soc-victim

1. Start with the full day

24 hours on 31 October. 17,416 alerts across the day, and this incident is a small cluster inside the 23:00 block.



1. Full day in UTC, no query, no custom rules.
2. 17,416 alerts. Most are audit and PAM chatter.
3. The 23:00 block contains the incident at 23:36. Three test windows share this block, and this is the third.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR IN THE LOGS

Relative size

The incident is a sliver of a busy day. At this scale a one minute event is invisible.

Time match

23:36 sits inside the 23:00 block. Start there.

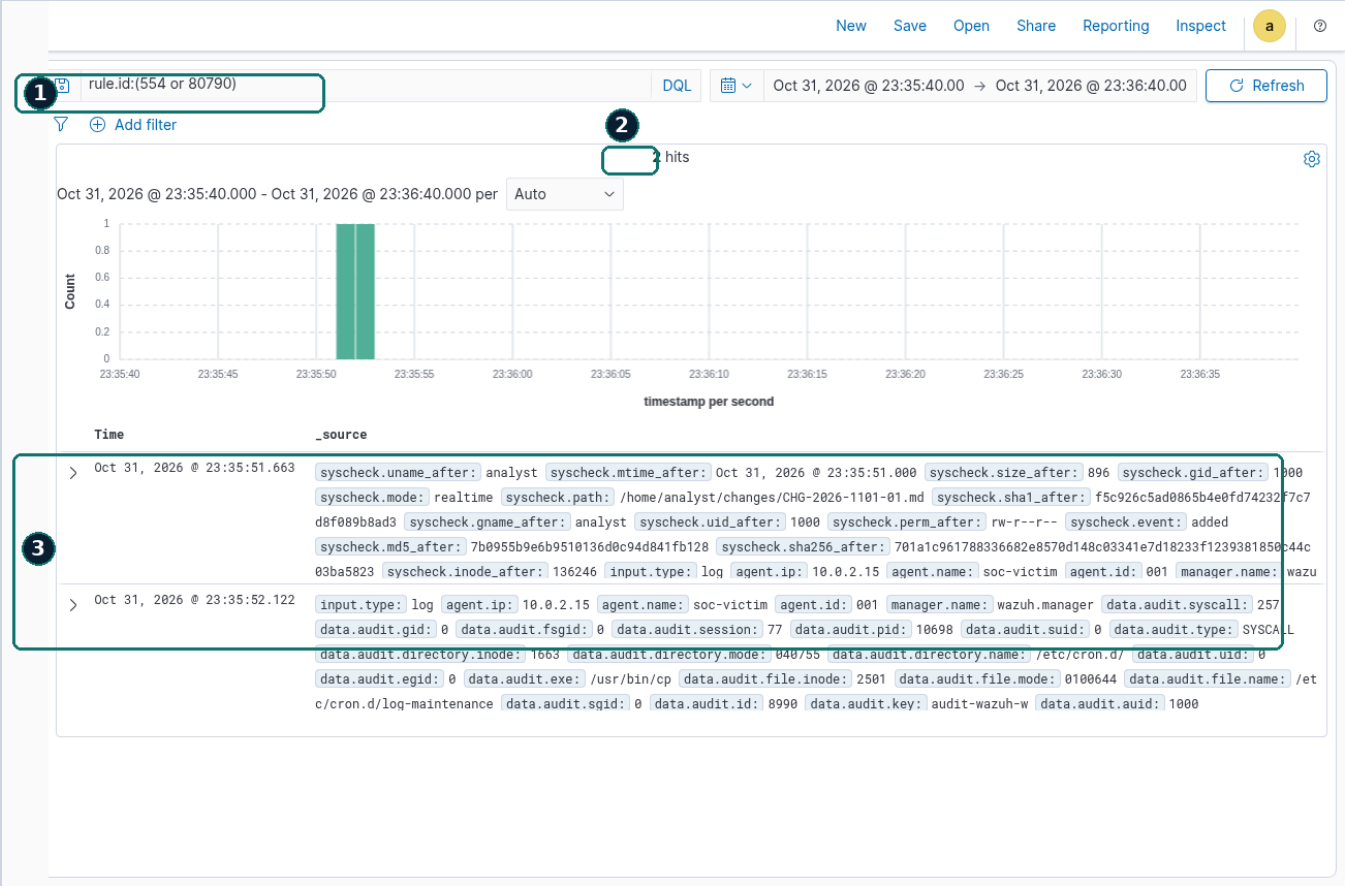
Do not merge

Nearby blocks are other tests. Only one block belongs to this ticket.

> At 24 hours the event is sub-pixel. That is why the next page narrows to the minute.

2. Stock rules see files appear

554 reports a file added and 80790 records the cron file creation. Both are stock Wazuh.



1. Query on the two stock rules.
2. Two hits at 23:35:51 and 23:35:52.
3. The rows name the cron file and the audit command.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR IN THE LOGS

Paths

/etc/cron.d/log-maintenance and /etc/systemd/system/logrotate-check.*

Sequence

All three files land in the same second.

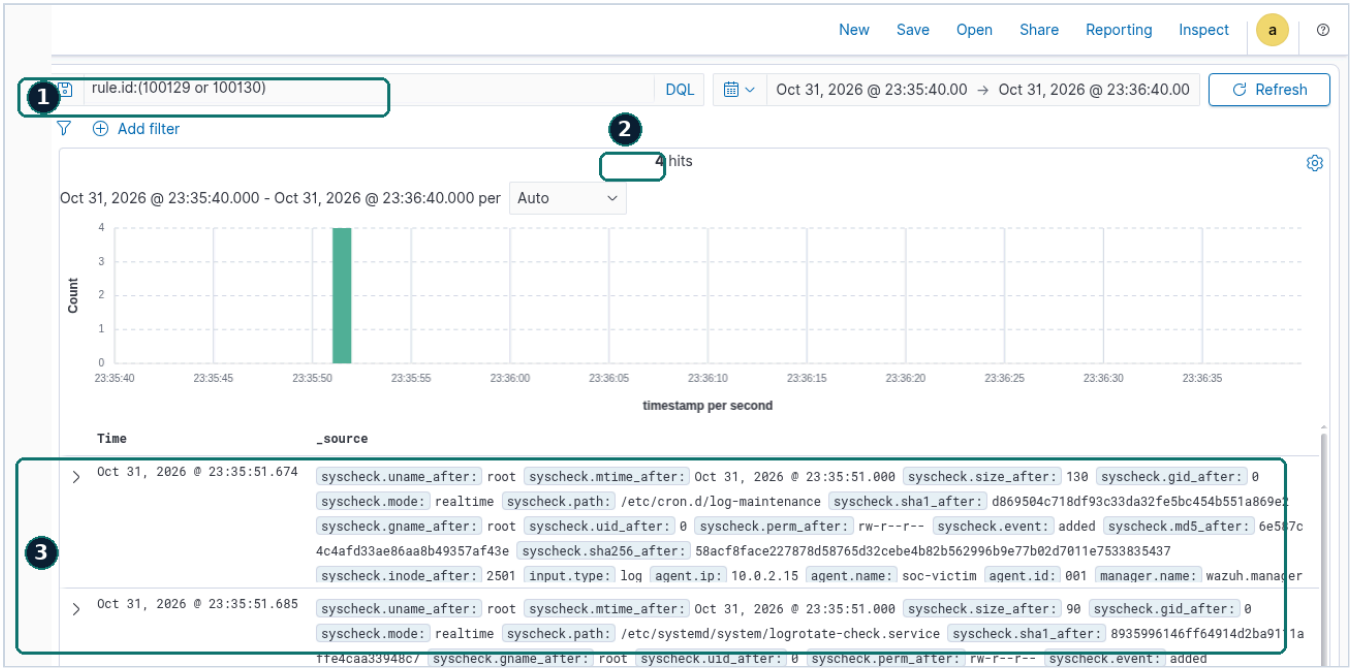
Actor

sudo from the analyst account.

> Stock rules cannot tell an approved change from persistence. That is the triage question.

3. Custom rules fire on the same change

100129 and 100130 were written for persistence. They fire correctly here, and that is the point of the exercise.



1. Query on the persistence rules.
2. Four hits: one cron file and three systemd changes.
3. The paths match the approved change, not an unknown artifact.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR IN THE LOGS

Cron path

/etc/cron.d/log-maintenance.

Systemd paths

logrotate-check.service and .timer.

Enable link

The timer is enabled, as the change record says.

> A rule that fires on an approved change is still correct. The ticket closes with evidence, not by weakening the rule.

4. The change timeline

Six alerts, all within one second. The order is file added, rule fires, audit confirms.

soc-lab, INC-006, alert chain, UTC

```
$ jq -r '.[] | select(.rule.id=="554" or .rule.id=="80790"
      or .rule.id=="100129" or .rule.id=="100130")
      | "\(.timestamp[11:19])  \(.rule.id)  \(.rule.description)"' \
      docs/evidence/INC-006-alerts.json
23:35:51  554  File added to the system.
23:35:51  100129  FIM: cron file added or modified (possible persistence)
23:35:51  100130  FIM: systemd unit or enable-link changed (possible persistence)
23:35:51  100130  FIM: systemd unit or enable-link changed (possible persistence)
23:35:51  100130  FIM: systemd unit or enable-link changed (possible persistence)
23:35:52  80790  Audit: Created: /etc/cron.d/log-maintenance.
```

1. 554 at 23:35:51: a file was added.
2. 100129 and 100130 fire on the paths in the change record.
3. 80790 at 23:35:52: audit confirms the cron file creation.

ALERT MIX

RULE	ALERTS	WHAT IT ADDS
554	1	File added
100129	1	Cron file rule
100130	3	Systemd unit and links
80790	1	Audit record

> Six alerts in one second is a change transaction, not a campaign. Read the change record before the alert count.

5. The change record

The record names the owner, the window, the purpose, and the expected hashes.

soc-lab, INC-006, change record

```
$ sed -n '1,18p' docs/evidence/INC-006-change-record.md
# CHG-2026-1101-01: Nightly log maintenance
| Field | Value |
|---|---|
| Status | Approved |
| Requester | analyst |
| Approver | lab-change-manager |
| Window | 2026-11-01 06:30 UTC |
| Purpose | Remove rotated logs older than 7 days. Add a logrotate health check |
| Risk | Low |
## Files
| Path | SHA-256 |
|---|---|
| /etc/cron.d/log-maintenance |
58acf8face227878d58765d32cebe4b82b562996b9e77b02d7011e7533835437 |
| /etc/systemd/system/logrotate-check.service |
6a0555d9e6831f2dcf2b208e7f7bf4da9473f145b4d31b46ebde76def3a50f19 |
| /etc/systemd/system/logrotate-check.timer |
83d683d881cc93e29c2f56f6925756b60d53c84f4234e2bbdeac060d87658cd8 |
```

1. Change ID CHG-2026-1101-01, status Approved.
2. Window 2026-11-01 06:30 UTC, which is 23:30 the previous day in local time.
3. The record lists the three paths and their SHA-256 values.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR IN THE LOGS

Change ID

Quote it in the ticket.

Approver

A named approver, not a chat message.

Hashes

The record provides the expected values.

Rollback

A written rollback procedure.

> An approved change with no hash list is weaker evidence. This one has all three.

6. Verify the hashes and state

The last step is a comparison. If the on-disk hashes match the record, the alert is a benign true positive.

soc-lab, INC-006, hash and state check

```
$ sha256sum /etc/cron.d/log-maintenance \
  /etc/systemd/system/logrotate-check.service \
  /etc/systemd/system/logrotate-check.timer
58acf8face227878d58765d32cebe4b82b562996b9e77b02d7011e7533835437  /etc/cron.d/log-maintenance
6a0555d9e6831f2dcf2b208e7f7bf4da9473f145b4d31b46ebde76def3a50f19
/etc/systemd/system/logrotate-check.service
83d683d881cc93e29c2f56f6925756b60d53c84f4234e2bbdeac060d87658cd8
/etc/systemd/system/logrotate-check.timer
$ systemctl is-active logrotate-check.timer
active
```

1. All three hashes match the change record exactly.
2. The timer is active, which matches the stated purpose.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR IN THE LOGS

Hash comparison

Match all three, not just the cron file.

Service state

Active and enabled as planned.

Closure language

Benign true positive, not a false positive.

> The rule did its job. The change was authorised. Both statements belong in the ticket.

7. How to capture this evidence

1. **Start broad**

   The change window, empty query.

2. **Stock rules**

   File added and audit creation.

   ```
   rule.id:(554 or 80790)
   ```

3. **Custom rules**

   Persistence rules that fired.

   ```
   rule.id:(100129 or 100130)
   ```

4. **Read the change record**

   Change ID, window, approver, hashes.

   ```
   sed -n '1,20p' docs/evidence/INC-006-change-record.md
   ```

5. **Compare hashes on the host**

   Reading the files does not run them. Record the comparison result.

   ```
   sha256sum /etc/cron.d/log-maintenance \
     /etc/systemd/system/logrotate-check.service \
     /etc/systemd/system/logrotate-check.timer
   ```

6. **Record service state**

   Matches the change purpose.

   ```
   systemctl is-active logrotate-check.timer
   ```

> Close with hashes and a change ID. Do not close by disabling the rule that found it.

8. What to look for

Change ID before alert count
The record is the primary evidence.

Window match
File times must sit inside the approved window.

Hash match
All files, not just the loudest one.

Purpose match
A log rotation timer matches the stated purpose.

Rule still valid
A benign true positive does not mean the rule is wrong.

COMMON PITFALLS

Calling it a false positive
The rule fired correctly. The activity was authorised.

Skipping the hash check
A change ID alone can be forged or stale.

Disabling the rule
That hides the next unauthorised change.

Verdict: benign true positive, closed. Change CHG-2026-1101-01 approved the files, the hashes match, and the timer is active as planned.